



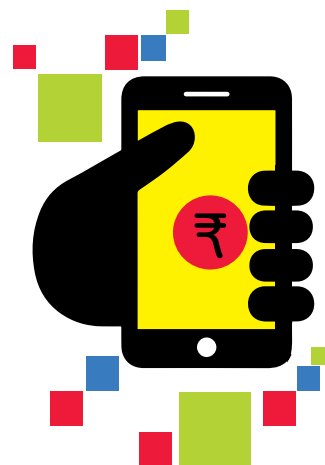
The Need for Speed

5G IS ALL SET to revolutionise consumer experience and industrial automation in the New Year. 5G services are expected to be available across the country over the next few months—improving data speed for retail consumers and opening up business opportunities for companies in OTT and gaming. They will also help manufacturers adopt Industry 4.0 practices that allows greater automation and usage of robotics—improving production efficiencies. Is the age of high-speed internet finally upon us?

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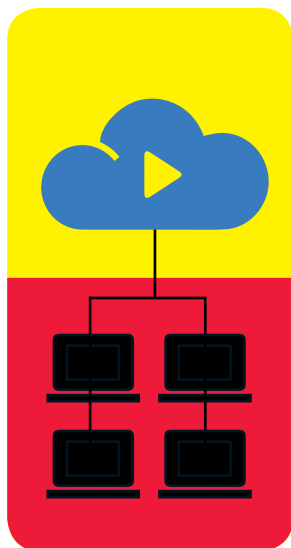
CURRENCY BYTES

WHILE THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) launched pilot projects for retail and whole-sale e-rupee in 2022, it is only in 2023 that the e-rupee may become a reality for you and me. Digital payments are expected to become much faster, transparent and efficient on the back of blockchain technology. The government is also expected to focus on the use of CBDC for remittance purposes.



MR RICHIE RICH

WILL GAUTAM ADANI overtake Elon Musk and Bernard Arnault to become the world's richest individual in 2023? He may, or he may not. But with gains of over \$49 billion in net worth in 2022, Adani has not only emerged as the highest wealth gainer in the year but also become the world's third-richest individual. Going by his track record, it may come as no surprise if Adani's steady hands take him to the top spot in 2023, leaving behind maverick Musk, who has lost \$109 billion in 2022, and luxury giant LVMH's Arnault, who tops the list.



LOCKED IN BATTLE

Come 2023 and the battle between the various OTT platforms will intensify further. At stake are revenues of over ₹21,000 crore by 2026 (a growth of 14.1 per cent CAGR) as per PwC. However, monetisation is a challenge as content costs are rising, while ARPUs are low. OTT players are now experimenting with revenue generation streams—Amazon Prime Video has forayed into sports while Netflix is expected to roll out its ad-supported version in India.

